

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 33

**PREVIOUS YEARS QUESTIONS
&
PRACTICE MCQ**



MCQ NO - 1

Which of the following are correctly matched?

FOREIGN TRAVELLER

1. Ibn-e-Batuta
2. Domingos Paes
3. Nicolo de Conti
4. Abdur Razzak

RULER

- A) Muhammad bin Tughlaq
- B) Krishna Dev Raya
- C) Deva Raya II
- D) Deva Raya I

Choose the correct code

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) All of the above

 Learning Space **EXPLANATION** Learning Space

- Moroccan Traveller **Ibn Batuta** visited India during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughlaq. Ibn Batuta called him “an ill-starred idealist”.
 - **Nicolo de Conti** visited India during the period of **Deva Raya I** and **Abdur Razzak** during **Deva Raya II**
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- Learning Space

MCQ NO - 2

Who introduced the new war techniques called the Tulughma and the Araba in India?

- a) Babur
- b) Akbar
- c) Jahangir
- d) Aurangzeb



EXPLANATION

- The new war tactics introduced by Babur were
 - a) Tulughma
 - b) Araba .
- **TULUGHMA** meant dividing the whole army into various units, viz. the Left, the Right and the Centre.
- The Left and Right divisions were further subdivided into **Forward and Rear divisions**. Through this, **a small army could be used to surround the enemy from all the sides**.
- The Centre Forward division was then provided with carts (**ARABA**) which were placed in rows facing the enemy and tied to each other with animal hide ropes.
- Behind them were placed cannons protected **and supported by mantelettas** which could be used to easily maneuver the canons. These two tactics made Babur's artillery lethal.
- The **guns and cannons could be fired without any fear** of being hit as **they were shielded by the bullock carts** which were held in place due to the hide ropes holding them together. The nozzle of the heavy cannons could also be easily changed as they could be maneuvered by the mantelets which were provided with wheels.

MCQ NO - 3

Consider the following statements regarding the work and responsibilities of Mir-Bakhshi during the reign of Akbar:

1. The Mir bakhshi was also the head of the intelligence and information agencies of the empire.
2. Intelligence officers (barids) and news reporters (waqia-navis) were posted to all parts of the empire and their reports were presented to the emperor at the court through the mir bakhshi.
3. It has been seen that the diwan and the mir bakhshi were almost on a par with, and supported and checked, each other.

Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

**EXPLANATION**

- The head of the military department was called the mir bakhshi.
- It was the mir bakhshi who was considered the head of the nobility.
- The mir bakhshi was also the head of the intelligence and information agencies of the empire. Intelligence officers (barids) and news reporters (waqia-navis) were posted to all parts of the empire.
- Their reports were presented to the emperor at the court through the mir bakhshi.



AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)**CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION****MIR BAKSHI**

- 1 The head of the military administration was *Mir Bakshi* who was also considered as head of the nobility.
- 2 Recommendations for appointment to mansabs or for promotions were made to the emperor after duly endorsed by him only.
- 3 Once the emperor accepted the recommendation, it was sent to the diwan for confirmation and for assigning a jagir to the appointee.
- 4 The Mir Bakshi was also the head of the intelligence and information agencies of the empire. **Barids** (intelligence officers) were posted to all the parts of the empire.
- 5 Their reports were presented to the emperor at the court through Mir Bakshi.
- 6 He kept a strict watch over proper maintenance of the sanctioned size of armed contingents and war equipage by the mansabdars.

MCQ NO - 4

Consider the following statements regarding the jurisdiction of work and responsibility of mir saman:

- I. Mir saman was in charge of the imperial household, including the supply of all the provisions and articles for the use of the inmates of the harem or the female apartments.
- II. Many of these articles were manufactured under supervision in royal workshops called karkhanas.
- III. The maintenance of etiquette at the court, the control of the royal bodyguard, etc., were all under the overall supervision of this officer.

Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) Only I
- b) I and II
- c) II and III
- d) All of the above

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)**CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION****MIR SAMAN**

- 1** The *Mir Saman* was the officer in-charge of the royal household and royal karkhanas.
- 2** Functions of Mir Saman:
 1. He was responsible for all kinds of purchases, manufacturing of different articles for the use, and their storage for the royal household.
 2. The maintenance of etiquette at the court, the control of the royal body guard, etc., were all under his supervision.
- 3** Only nobles who enjoyed the complete confidence of the emperor were appointed to this office.

MCQ NO - 5

Consider the following statements regarding the Akbar's Rajput policy:

- I. Akbar's Rajput policy was combined with a policy of broad religious toleration.
- II. He abolished the jizyah which was sometimes used by the ulama to humiliate non-Muslims.
- III. He had earlier abolished the pilgrim-tax, and the practice of forcible conversion of prisoners of war.

Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) Only I
- b) I and II
- c) I and III
- d) All of the above

MCQ NO - 6

Consider the following statements about Council of Forty:

1. Council of forty or Turkan-i-Chihalgani was a form of sharing power between the highest nobles and the King.
2. It was introduced by Balban to gain the confidence of nobles who were becoming increasingly resistant to the authority.
3. It was later dissolved by Iltutmish.

Choose the correct code

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above



EXPLANATION



- Iltutmish (1210-1236 AD) was the third ruler of the Mamluk dynasty of Delhi of Turkic origin.
- He constituted a corp of 40 loyal slaves, Amirs Known as Turkan-i-Chihalgani, a form of sharing power between the highest nobles and the king.
- Balban weakend this system and strengthened his rule by adopting espionage and counterespionage system and his personal secret police, called *Barids*



SLAVE DYNASTY (1206 -1290)

IMPORTANT POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT ILTUTMISH



10 Iluttmish had also created a new class of ruling elite of forty powerful military leaders **Turkan-i-Chahalgani** or **Chalisa** or **Forty**. (replaced 'Maliks')

- ✓ These were Turkish amirs (nobles) who advised and helped the Sultan in administering the Sultanate.
- ✓ After the death of Iluttmish, this group assumed great power in its hands.

11 Introduced **Iqtadari system**:

- ✓ He divided his empire into **Iqtas** (assignment of land in lieu of salary).
- ✓ Every **Iqtadars** had to maintain law and order and collect revenue.
- ✓ After deducting own salary and expenses, they had to send the surplus to central government.

Note - **Iqtadars** were transferable.

SLAVE DYNASTY

QUTBUDDIN AIBAK
[1206 - 1210]

ARAMSHAH
[1210 - 1211]

ILTUTMISH
[1211 - 1236]

RAZIYA
[1236 - 1240]

BAHRAM SHAH
[1240 - 1242]

ALAUDDIN MASUD SHAH
[1242 - 1246]

NASIR - UD- DIN MAHMUD
[1246 - 1265]

BALBAN
[1266 - 1287]

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MEDIEVAL HISTORY

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ANSWER KEY

1 - a

2 - a

3 - d

4 - d

5 - d

6 - b

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